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Away boredom! The Power of Web Compels You!

Ahmed Shaikh

Ah yes, boredom. It seems that most of our lives, we're either inflicting it upon others, or it's being inflicted upon us. But things can get better. Our collective souls must have scored some positive karma somewhere along the line—for release is a Web site away. Let these pages be a spiritual guide to nirvana and bliss, no trees required, just a decent connection to the Internet (a small miracle in itself?), and sundry Web plugins.

Our sole weapon against boredom is going to be games: small, easy-to-play arcade or word games created for the Web browser. Most of this content requires the Flash or Shockwave plugins—if you surf the Internet regularly, you likely have all you need. If you don't, check out our companion DVD and CD. Some of the sites we talk about might require Java, or a proprietary plugin such as Vircos Webplayer. You will need to bear this plugin dance, for

attaining nirvana must always be a test. The good news is that modern Web browsers are capable of prompting you to install the correct plugin.

What you need to look out for, however, is malware. If you have been reading these pages regularly, you must be well aware of a dozen ways your system can be infected with malicious software. Downloading blindly or clicking blindly are probably the top two reasons. So be aware of what you click; don't download anything that looks suspicious (avoid downloading from these sites, we would suggest). And keep both a virus scanner and a spyware/

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